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Bazaar

PS Vita Review

The hardcore gamer's companion!

On first impressions the Vita looks like the original PSP on steroids. The device is light enough to carry in a bag, but it isn't small enough to fit in your pocket. It has a glossy black finish making it a finger-print magnet.

The Vita has a gorgeous 5-inch display, which will make your jaw drop the minute you power on the device. The biggest downer to the screen is that it is susceptible to glare.

The rear of the device has a touch panel. The device has two VGA cameras, one in the front and the other at the rear without a flash.

To sum up, the PS Vita feels like Charlize Theron from *Aeon Flux* in your hands and that is a very good thing!

Sony has finally paid homage to gamer's prayers and added two analog sticks along with the D-Pad, the standard PlayStation controls and shoulder buttons.

As if 15-buttons on the device weren't enough, Sony has thrown in everything here but the kitchen sink. You have a six-axis motion sensing system (three-axis gyroscope, three-axis accelerometer), three-axis electronic compass and a front touchscreen and a rear touch panel, not to mention the two cameras that can be used in augmented reality games. In short, your hands will be all over this device.

The interface of the Vita is like iOS. You have app icons that fill up the screen. 10 apps can be held in one screen and you can rearrange them to your liking.

The Vita has brought two unique formats - a proprietary memory card and a unique SD card style format for the games.

The Vita memory card comes in 4, 8, 16 and 32GB variants. The price of these memory cards is approx. ₹1,000, ₹1,480, ₹2,690 and ₹4,935 respectively. These are expensive in this day and age, where a 32 GB microSD card costs ₹2,100 (approx.) You will have to purchase a memory card if you decide to download games digitally or want to use the device to watch movies or listen to music.

To put things into perspective, *Uncharted: Golden Abyss* is roughly a 3.3 GB download. Most of the AAA games range between 1 to 3 GB in terms of their storage. So if you thought you can avoid picking up a memory card, think again. You may just need one and a higher capacity one if you intend to carry your music, videos and games on the device. You can transfer media from your PC to the Vita via a proprietary USB cable.

The launch lineup for the Vita is spectacular. There's something for everyone. The prices of games range from a few hundred rupees to ₹2,800. You have the likes of *FIFA Football*, *ModNation Racers: Road Trip*, *Ninja Gaiden Sigma Plus*, *Rayman Origins*, *Ultimate Marvel vs Capcom*, *Uncharted: Golden Abyss*, *Wipeout 2048* to name a few.



At a stretch, the device lasted for around 4.5 hours of gaming, which isn't extremely good, but it isn't bad either.

With all the awesomeness and potential the Vita has to offer it does come at a very steep price. The Wi-Fi only model will cost you ₹19,990 and the 3G+Wi-Fi will cost you ₹24,990. That's more expensive than a PS3 or an Xbox 360. The games for the Vita too are priced at a premium ranging from ₹2,199 to ₹2,799 (yes, you will get cheaper downloadable games but we are referring to the full blown AAA titles). Plus if you need storage, you will have to pick up one of the expensive proprietary memory cards.

It's clear that the Vita isn't gunning for the casual audience that place games on their smartphones. The device is designed to be the hardcore gamer's companion. If you are an addict who needs his dose of gaming on the go, then this device is definitely for you. If not, then you may want to take a look at picking up a full-blown console as that will cost you around ₹16,000 and give you a better overall package.

Sameer Mitha

Specifications

Type: Portable gaming console; **Processor:** ARM Cortex A9 processor (Quad-core); **RAM:** 512MB; **Graphics:** Graphics: SGX543MP4+ GPU; **Display:** 5-inches (960x544 pixels), OLED type; **Storage:** Proprietary PS Vita Memory card; **Connectivity:** Wi-Fi and 3G (optional); **Battery:** 2210mAh

Contact

Sony India
Email: NA
Website: www.in.playstation.com
Price: ₹19,990 (Wi-Fi only); ₹24,990 (3G + Wi-Fi)

8.0/10

Features	8.0
Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality	8.5
Value for Money	7.0